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ASSEMBLY FOR COUPLING AN AESTHETIC MEMBER TO AN ACCESSORY

Abstract

An assembly for coupling an aesthetic member to an accessory. The assembly may include a base configured to be secured to the accessory. The assembly may include a topper configured to be removably coupled to the base, the topper including the aesthetic member, wherein the topper is removable to interchange the aesthetic member from the accessory.

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Background/Summary

FIELD

[0001] The present application relates to an assembly for coupling an aesthetic member to an accessory (e.g., shoes, hand bags, belts, hats, and the like) or item of clothing. In particular, the present application relates to an assembly for removably coupling an aesthetic member to a shoe.

BACKGROUND

[0002] Shoes are intended to protect and comfort the human foot when making contact with the ground. Shoes are also used as a fashion article. Fashion has often dictated many shoe design elements, such as types of materials, colors, heel heights, and flexibility. Additionally, fashion accessories, such as hand bags, belts, hats, and the like are added to change the look or appearance of a person.

[0003] Fashion is one of the primary contributors to pollution, creating 10% of worldwide greenhouse gas emissions annually and negatively impacting our global crisis of climate change. Accordingly, a quick and easy way to add an aesthetic member to change the appearance of an accessory (e.g., shoes, hand bags, belts, hats, and the like) would be desirable and important to reducing the impact of fashion on pollution. Additionally, the ability to reuse the aesthetic member on different types of accessories (e.g., shoes, hand bags, belts, hats, and the like) would be cost effective for the user while providing an endless number of options.

SUMMARY

[0004] In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to an assembly for coupling an aesthetic member to an accessory, the assembly including: a base configured to be secured to the accessory; a topper configured to be removably coupled to the base, the topper including the aesthetic member; wherein the topper is removable to interchange the aesthetic member from the accessory.

[0005] In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to an accessory system including: an accessory; a base configured to be coupled to the accessory; a first topper configured to be removably coupled to the base, the first topper including a first aesthetic member; a second topper configured to be removably coupled to the base, the second topper including a second aesthetic member that is different from the first aesthetic member, wherein the first topper is removable and replaceable with the second topper to modify the accessory from having the first aesthetic member to the second aesthetic member.

[0006] In some aspects, the techniques described herein relate to a method for altering a design of an accessory, the method including: providing a base coupled to the accessory; coupling a first topper to the base, the first topper including a first aesthetic member such that the accessory has a first design; removing a first topper from a base; and coupling a second topper to the base, the second topper having a second aesthetic member such that the accessory has a second design.

[0007] Other aspects of the present disclosure will become apparent by consideration of the detailed description and accompanying drawings.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0008] FIG. 1 illustrates a perspective view of an accessory including an assembly for coupling an aesthetic member to the accessory.

[0009] FIG. 2 illustrates a perspective view of the assembly of FIG. 1 including a base and a topper according to an embodiment.

[0010] FIG. 3 illustrates a side view of the assembly of FIG. 1.

[0011] FIG. 4 illustrates an exploded view of the assembly of FIG. 1.

[0012] FIG. 5 illustrates another exploded view of the assembly of FIG. 1.

[0013] FIG. 6 illustrates a top view of the base of FIG. 1.

[0014] FIG. 7 illustrates a rear view of the topper of FIG. 1.

[0015] FIG. 8 illustrates a kit including a plurality of bases and a plurality of toppers for use with any of the plurality of bases.

[0016] FIG. 9 is an exemplary method for altering the design of an accessory.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0017] Before any embodiments of the application are explained in detail, it is to be understood that the application, and the devices and method described herein, are not limited in their application to the details of construction and the arrangement of components set forth in the following description or illustrated in the following drawings. The devices and methods in this application are capable of other embodiments and of being practiced or of being carried out in various ways.

[0018] FIG. 1 illustrates an assembly **10** for removably and interchangeably coupling an aesthetic member **14**, **14'**, **14''** to an accessory **20**. In the embodiment illustrated herein, the accessory **20** is a shoe. In other or alternative embodiments, the assembly **10** may be used with another accessory (such as a handbag, belt, hat, etc.) or item of clothing (e.g., a dress, suit jacket, etc.). As shown in FIGS. 2-5, the assembly **10** includes a base **30** and a topper **40**. The base **30** is configured to be coupled to the accessory **20**, and the topper **40** is configured to be removably coupled to the base **30**. The topper **40** includes the aesthetic member **14**, such that the aesthetic member **14** is removably coupled to the accessory **20**. With respect to FIG. 8, the topper **40** is removable and replaceable with another topper **40'**, **40''**, each having another aesthetic member **14'**, **14''**, as will be discussed in greater detail below, to quickly and easily alter the design or look of the accessory **20**. In the illustrated embodiments, the base **30** and the topper **40** have the embodied shape, but it should be understood that the base **30** and the topper **40** may have any suitable shape.

[0019] With respect to FIGS. 2-6, the base **30** includes a body **50** having a first side **54**, a second side **58** opposite the first side **54**, a third side **62**, and a fourth side **66** opposite the third side **62**. The base **30** may be coupled to the accessory **20** via a rivet, adhesive, or other suitable coupling mechanism, as discussed in greater detail below. The coupling mechanism secures the base **30** to the accessory **20** such that the base remains in place for when the topper **40** is added and removed.

[0020] The first side **54** includes a first surface **74** that is configured to be positioned adjacent an outer surface of the accessory **20**. The first surface **74** is configured to contact an outer surface of the shoe **20**, such that the first surface **74** abuts the outer surface of the shoe **20**. The first surface **74** may also include a first projection **78** (e.g., post) and a second projection **82** (e.g., post) extending therefrom. In the illustrated embodiment, the projections **78**, **82** are part of the coupling mechanism. That is, the projections **78**, **82** are configured to be a rivet foot and therefore each include an aperture extending through **86**, **90** that is configured to receive and secure a cap (not shown). Although not shown, when coupled to the shoe, the projections **78**, **82** may extend into and/or through a portion of the shoe such that the base **30** is positioned adjacent and contacts the outer surface of the shoe. The caps may be coupled to the projections **86**, **90** from within the shoe and positioned adjacent an inner surface of the shoe to couple the base **30** to the shoe. In other embodiments, there may be a single projection or more than two projections. In other embodiments, the projections **78**, **82** may be omitted such that the first surface **74** is generally smooth. In such case, the base **30** may be coupled to the shoe in other ways using other or additional coupling mechanisms, as discussed below.

[0021] In the illustrated embodiment, the body **50** is generally curved such that the second surface **74** is a generally arcuate surface. That is, the body **50** has a radial concavity having a radius **R1** (FIG. 3) measured from a point on an axis **70** that extends through the body **50** from the first side **54** to the second side **58**. The radial concavity of the body **50** enables the first surface **74** of the base **30** to contact a curved outer surface of the shoe. In other embodiments, the body **50** may have a radial concavity having a different radius **R1**. Alternatively, in other embodiments, the body **50** may not be curved, such that the first side **54** has a generally planar surface.

[0022] The second side **58** includes a second surface **100** that is configured to face outwardly from the accessory **20**. In the illustrated embodiment, the second side **58** also includes a first recess **104** and a second recess **108**. The first recess **104** is positioned adjacent the third side **62** and the second recess **108** is positioned adjacent the fourth side **66**. A lip **112** extends about both the first recess

104 and the second recess **108** and is recessed relative to the second surface **100**. In other constructions, the second side may include a single recess or more than two recesses.

[0023] As shown herein, the base **30** may additionally or alternatively include a first loop **116** coupled to and extending from the third side **62** and a second loop **120** coupled to and extending from the fourth side **120**. The loops **116**, **120** may be used to couple the base **30** to the shoe **20**, in addition to or alternatively than the projections **86**, **90**. That is, in some embodiments, the loops **116**, **120** may be sewn to the shoe **20** to couple the base **30** to the shoe **20**. In other embodiments, the loops **116**, **120** may be used to thread one or more straps therethrough (e.g., in the front at or adjacent to a toe region of the shoe, in the rear at or adjacent to an ankle region of the shoe, or anywhere in between the front and rear of the shoe). In some constructions, the first loop **116** and the second loop **120** are integral or formed with the base **30**. In some embodiments, the base **30'** may have an alternative configuration in which the loops **116**, **120** may be omitted therefrom (FIG. **8**). When omitted, the base **30** may be riveted to the shoe (as discussed above). Alternatively, the base **30**, **30'** may be coupled to the shoe in other suitable ways, such as by welding, adhesive, or another suitable method.

[0024] With respect to FIG. **6**, in the illustrated embodiment, the base **30** includes a first magnet **130** and a second magnet **134**. The first magnet **130** is received in the first recess **104** and the second magnet **134** is received in the second recess **108**. In the illustrated embodiment, the magnets **130**, **134** may be flush with the lip **112** or below the lip **112**. Alternatively, the magnets **130**, **134** may extend from the respective recess **104**, **108** such that they project above the lip **112**. In other embodiments, the base **30** may have other suitable configurations that accommodate one or more magnets. For example, the base **30** may include a single recess and a single magnet or may include a single recess and multiple magnets.

[0025] Also, with respect to FIGS. **4** and **5**, in the illustrated embodiment, the base **30** has a plurality of apertures **140** that extend through the body **50** from the first side **54** to the second side **58**. In other embodiments, the apertures **140** may be bores with an open end in the second side **58** and a closed end, such that the bore does not extend all the way from the second side **58** through the body **50**. The apertures **140** are positioned between the recesses **104**, **108** and a peripheral edge **150** of the body **50**. There are four apertures **140** in the illustrated embodiments. There are two apertures **140** that are positioned adjacent the third side **62** and two apertures **140** that are positioned adjacent the fourth side **66**. In other embodiments, there may be more or fewer apertures **140** positioned at various locations adjacent the peripheral edge **150** of the body **50**. In other embodiments, these apertures **140** may be omitted.

[0026] With respect to FIGS. **2-5** and **7**, the topper **40** includes a body **160** having a first side **164**, a second side **168** opposite the first side **164**, a third side **172**, and a fourth side **176** opposite the third side **172**. The first side **164** of the topper **40** includes a first surface **184** and the second side **168** includes a second surface **208** that is configured to face outwardly from the accessory **20**. A first projection **188** and a second projection **192** extend from the first surface **184**. The first and second projections **188**, **192** each include a recess **196**, **200**.

[0027] In the illustrated embodiment, each of the recesses **196**, **200** includes a magnet **202**, **204**. In other embodiments, there may be more or fewer recesses **196** and more or fewer magnets **202**, **204**. The magnets **202**, **204** are configured to attract to the respective magnets **130**, **134** of the base **30**. Accordingly, the magnets of the topper **40** align with and contact the magnets **130**, **134** of the base **30** to couple the topper **40** to the base **30**. When the topper **40** is coupled to the base **30**, the projections **188**, **192** are configured to be seated against (e.g., contact) the lip **112** and the first surface **184** of the topper **40** contacts the second surface **100** of the base **30**. In the illustrated embodiment, a peripheral edge **212** of the topper **40** extends beyond the peripheral edge **150** of the base **30**.

[0028] In the other embodiments, the magnets **202**, **204** may be omitted such that the recesses **196**, **200** are empty. In such case, when the topper **40** is coupled to the base **30**, the recess **196** of the first

projection **188** is configured to receive or be positioned adjacent to the first magnet **130** and the recess **200** of the second projection **192** is configured to receive or be positioned adjacent to the second magnet **134**. Additionally, the topper **40** may be at least partially formed from metal such that the magnets **130**, **134** attract to the topper **40** to secure the topper **40** to the base **30**. Still, when the topper **40** is coupled to the base **30**, the projections **188**, **192** are configured to be seated against (e.g., contact) the lip **112** and the first surface **184** of the topper **40** contacts the second surface **100** of the base **30**.

[0029] In the illustrated embodiment, the body **160** of the topper **40** is configured to be matingly coupled to the body **50** of the base **30**. Accordingly, the body **160** of the topper **40** is generally curved, such that the first surface **184** is a generally arcuate surface. That is, the body **160** has a radial concavity having a radius **R2** (FIG. **3**) measured from a point on an axis **180** that extends through the body **160** from the first side **164** to the second side **168**. In the illustrated embodiment, the radial concavity of the topper **40** is the same as the radial concavity of the base **30**, such that radius **R2** is equal to **R1**. In other embodiments, like the body **50** of the base **30**, the body **160** of the topper **40** may have a radial concavity having a different radius **R2**. Alternatively, as noted above, in other embodiments, the body **160** may not be curved, such that the first side **184** has a generally planar surface.

[0030] In the illustrated embodiment, the first and second projections **188**, **192** of the topper **40**, collectively, may be considered an alignment feature of the topper **40**, while the lip **112** of the base **30** may be considered to be an alignment feature of the base **30**. That is, the first and second projections **188**, **192** are configured to be matingly seated against the lip **112** to align, and therefore properly position, the topper **40** relative to the base **30**.

[0031] Also, with respect to FIGS. **4** and **5**, in the illustrated embodiment, the topper **40** includes a plurality of peripheral projections **220** extending from the first surface **184** of the topper **40**. Each of the peripheral projections **220** are configured to be received in one of the apertures **40** (or bores) of the base **30**. The number of peripheral projections **220** of the topper **40** therefore corresponds to the number of apertures **140** in the base **30**. In other embodiments, there may be more apertures **40** than peripheral projections **220**, such that the peripheral projections **220** may be received in some of the apertures **40**, while others of the apertures **40** may not receive anything. That is, any number of the apertures **40** may be used to receive a peripheral projection **220** depending on the weight of the aesthetic member **14**, **14'**, **14''**. In other words, a heavier aesthetic member may require more peripheral projections **220** to be received in more apertures **40**, whereas a lighter aesthetic member may require less peripheral projections **220** to be received in less apertures **40**. Also, these peripheral projections **220** may be omitted in some embodiments. Collectively, the peripheral projections **220** may be considered another alignment feature of the topper **40**, while, collectively, the apertures **140** of the base **30** may be considered another alignment feature of the base **30**. In the illustrated embodiment, there are four peripheral projections **220** and four apertures **140**. In other or additional embodiments, there may be more (e.g., more than four) or fewer (e.g., less than four) peripheral projections **220** and apertures **140**. Additionally, as shown herein, the base **30** and the topper **40** are symmetrical. Therefore, the topper **40** may be coupled to base **30** in a first orientation or a second orientation which is rotated **180** degrees relative to the first orientation.

[0032] In the illustrated embodiment, the user may be alerted to the proper engagement between the topper **40** and the base **30** by an audible sound. That is, coupling the topper **40** to the base **30** causes the audible sound. Similarly, there is an audible sound when the topper **40** is removed from the base **30**.

[0033] As shown in FIG. **1**, the second surface **208** of the topper **40** includes the aesthetic member **14**. Accordingly, when the topper **40** is coupled to the base **30**, and therefore the accessory **20**, the aesthetic member **14** of the topper **40** is part of the design of the accessory **20**. Additionally, because the base **30** and the topper **40** are symmetrical, the topper **40** may be coupled to base **30** such that the aesthetic member **14** can be in the first orientation or the second orientation. The user

can remove the topper **40** to remove the aesthetic member **14** from the accessory **20**. Also, as shown in FIG. **8**, the topper **40'** is interchangeable with the other toppers **40'**, **40''** to change the aesthetic member **14** and therefore the design of the accessory **20**. Although only the specific details of the base **30** and the topper **40**, it should be understood that, except as otherwise noted, the base **30'** has the same features as the base **30** and the toppers **40'**, **40''** have the same features as the topper **40**. One or both of the bases **30**, **30'** and one or more of the toppers **40**, **40'**, **40''** may therefore form a kit.

[0034] In the examples shown herein, the topper **40** of FIGS. **1-5** and **7-8** is a first topper **40**. The second surface **208** of the first topper **40** includes the first aesthetic member **14**. In this case the first aesthetic member **40** is indicia **230** (e.g., logos, letters, numbers, symbols, etc.) that is formed on the second surface **208** of the first topper **40**. The indicia **230** may be integrally formed with or otherwise coupled to (e.g., by adhesive, welding, fastening, etc.) the first topper **40**. In the first orientation, the indicia **230** may be considered upside down from the perspective of the user, while in the second orientation, the indicia **230** may be considered right side up from the perspective of the user.

[0035] Further with respect to FIG. **8**, the first topper **40** is configured to be removed and replaced with a second topper **40'**. The second topper **40'** may include a first coupling configuration that is configured to secure a second aesthetic member (e.g., a bow, flower, rhinestone, buckle, feather, etc., not shown). The first coupling configuration may include a plurality of apertures **240** extending through the body **160** from the first side **164** to the second side **168**. In the illustrated embodiment, there are three apertures **240** arranged at a midpoint between the third side **172** and the fourth side **176**. The center aperture **240** has a greater diameter than the apertures **240** on either side thereof. The apertures **240** may have other configurations, orientations, and sizes. For example, the apertures **240** may be positioned in other locations relative the body **160** and/or there may be more or fewer apertures **140** having various sizes. Additionally, the first coupling configuration may include a first loop **244** coupled to and extending from the third side **172** and a second loop **248** coupled to and extending from the fourth side **176**. The apertures **240** and/or the loops **244**, **248** may be used to together or separately to couple the second aesthetic member to the second topper **40'**. The second aesthetic member may be coupled to the topper **40** (and in particular to one or more of the apertures **240** and/or loops **244**, **248**) in any suitable way (e.g., sewn, riveted, welded, straps threaded therethrough, adhesively, etc.).

[0036] Further with respect to FIG. **8**, the first topper **40** or the second topper **40'** are each configured to be removed and replaced with a third topper **40''**. The third topper **40''** may include a second coupling configuration that is configured to secure a third aesthetic member (e.g., a bow, flower, rhinestone, buckle, feather, etc., not shown). The second coupling configuration may include a projection **260** extending from the second surface **208**. In the illustrated embodiment, the projection **260** is arranged at a midpoint between the third side **172** and the fourth side **176**. The projection **260** may be positioned in other locations relative the body **160**, the projection **260** may have other suitable sizes and shapes (e.g., rectangle, oval, triangle, trapezoidal, etc.), and/or there may be additional projections **260** having various shapes and sizes. The projection **260** may be used to couple the third aesthetic member to the third topper **40''**. Although not shown, the third topper **40''**, like the second topper **40'**, may also include loops **244**, **248**. The third aesthetic member may be coupled to the topper **40** (and in particular to the projection **260** and/or loops **244**, **248** thereof) in any suitable way (e.g., sewn, riveted, welded, straps threaded therethrough, etc.). In still some embodiments, the projection **260** may be omitted entirely and/or include loops **244**, **248**. In such case, the third aesthetic member may be coupled to the topper **40** (and in particular to the top surface and/or loops **244**, **248** thereof) in any suitable way (e.g., sewn, riveted, welded, straps threaded therethrough, etc.).

[0037] One exemplary method for altering a design of an accessory **20** (e.g., a shoe) is shown in FIG. **9**. The method is discussed in the context of the altering the design of the accessory **20**, which

in this example is a shoe. In other embodiments, this method may be used for altering the design of another accessory (e.g., a handbag or a hat, etc.) or an item of clothing (e.g., a dress or suit jacket, etc.). At step 300, the method includes providing one of the bases 30, 30' of FIG. 8 to the accessory 20. At step 304, the method further includes coupling the first topper 40 to the base 30, 30'. The first topper 40 has the first aesthetic member 14. At step 308, the method includes removing the first topper 40 from the base 30, 30'. At step 312, the method includes coupling the second topper 40' to the base 30, 30'. The second topper 40' has the second aesthetic member 14'. As noted above, coupling the first topper 40 to the base 30, 30' and coupling the second topper 14' to the base includes magnetically coupling the first topper 40 to the base 30 and magnetically coupling the second topper 40' to the base 30, 30'. Additionally, in the embodiments herein, the method also includes aligning the first alignment feature of the first topper 40 with the second alignment feature of the base 30, 30' to couple to the first topper 40 to the base 30, 30', and aligning the first alignment feature of the second topper 40' with the second alignment feature of the base 30, 30' to couple to the second topper 40' to the base 30, 30'. Finally, the method also includes creating an audible sound when the first topper 40 is coupled to the base 30, 30' and creating the audible sound when the second topper 40' is coupled to the base 30, 30'. This same method may be repeated for removing the second topper 40' and replacing the second topper 40' with the third topper 40''.

[0038] The assembly and system of this disclosure are designed to be inherently and intentionally eco-friendly and sustainable. That is, the assembly and system of this disclosure provide the utility and global potential for formerly single-use accessories to become multiuse and help reduce overconsumption, especially on the larger accessories, by just interchanging the toppers to change the aesthetic members attached to the accessories. Furthermore, in some cases, the waste from manufacturing the accessory (e.g., the shoe) may be used to create the aesthetic member of the topper 40, 40', 40'' to further promote sustainability. The system created here for standardizing an assembly for coupling aesthetic members to accessories, therefore, has a potentially positive global impact to reduce waste and help slow climate change. A system such as this is much needed in the fashion industry.

[0039] Various features and advantages of the present disclosure are set forth in the following claims.

Claims

1. An assembly for coupling an aesthetic member to an accessory, the assembly comprising: a base configured to be secured to the accessory, the base including a first recess configured to receive a first magnet, and an aperture or a bore formed in the base adjacent a peripheral edge of the base: a topper configured to be removably coupled to the base, the topper including the aesthetic member, a second recess configured to receive a second magnet, and a protrusion extending from a peripheral edge of the topper, the protrusion configured to be received by the aperture or the bore of the base: wherein the topper is removable to interchange the aesthetic member from the accessory.
2. The assembly of claim 1, wherein the topper is a first topper and the aesthetic member is a first aesthetic member, and further comprising a second topper having a second aesthetic member, the second topper configured to be removably coupled to the base when the first topper is removed from the base.
3. The assembly of claim 2, wherein the first aesthetic member is indicia formed on a top surface of the first topper.
4. The assembly of claim 2, wherein the second topper includes a coupling configuration that is configured to secure the second aesthetic member to the second topper.
5. The assembly of claim 1, wherein the base includes a first alignment feature and the topper includes a second alignment feature, the first alignment feature and the second alignment features

configured to matingly engage to couple the topper to the base.

6. The assembly of claim 1, wherein the topper is magnetically coupled to the base.

7. The assembly of claim 1, wherein the base has a radial concavity that is same as the radial concavity of the topper.

8. The assembly of claim 1, wherein when the topper is coupled to the base there is an audible sound from a human perspective.

9. An accessory system comprising: an accessory: a base configured to be coupled to the accessory, the base including a first recess configured to receive a first magnet, and an aperture or a bore formed in the base adjacent a peripheral edge of the base: a first topper configured to be removably coupled to the base the first topper including a first aesthetic member, a second recess configured to receive a second magnet, and a first protrusion extending from a peripheral edge of the topper, the first protrusion configured to be received by the aperture or the bore of the base: a second topper configured to be removably coupled to the base, the second topper including a second aesthetic member that is different from the first aesthetic member, a third recess configured to receive a third magnet, and a second protrusion extending from a peripheral edge of the second topper, the second protrusion configured to be received by the aperture or the bore of the base, wherein the first topper is removable and replaceable with the second topper to modify the accessory from having the first aesthetic member to the second aesthetic member.

10. The accessory system of claim 9, wherein the first aesthetic member is indicia formed on a top surface of the first topper.

11. The accessory system of claim 9, wherein the second topper includes a coupling configuration that is configured to secure the second aesthetic member thereto.

12. The accessory system of claim 9, wherein the base includes a first alignment feature and each of the first topper and the second topper include a second alignment feature, the first alignment feature and the second alignment features configured to matingly engage to couple the respective first topper and second topper to the base.

13. The accessory system of claim 9, wherein the first topper and the second topper are magnetically coupled to the base.

14. The accessory system of claim 9, wherein the base has a radial concavity that is the same as a radial concavity of each of the first topper and the second topper.

15. The accessory system of claim 9, wherein each of the first topper and the second topper indicate engagement with the base by an audible sound from a human perspective.

16. The accessory system of claim 9, wherein the accessory is a shoe.

17. A method for altering a design of an accessory, the method comprising: providing a kit including a plurality of toppers, wherein the accessory includes a base secured to the accessory, each topper including a first recess configured to receive a first magnet, a second recess configured to receive a second magnet, and a protrusion extending from a peripheral edge of the topper, the protrusion configured to be received by an aperture or a bore formed within the base: coupling a first topper of the plurality of toppers to the base, the first topper including a first aesthetic member such that the accessory has a first design: removing the first topper from the base; and coupling a second topper of the plurality of toppers to the base, the second topper having a second aesthetic member such that the accessory has a second design.

18. The method of claim 17, wherein coupling the first topper to the base and coupling the second topper to the base includes magnetically coupling the first topper to the base and magnetically coupling the second topper to the base.

19. The method of claim 17, further comprising creating an audible sound from a human perspective when the first topper is coupled to the base and creating the audible sound when the second topper is coupled to the base.

20. The method of claim 17, further comprising aligning a first alignment feature of the first topper with a second alignment feature of the base to couple the first topper to the base, and aligning a

first alignment feature of the second topper with the second alignment feature of the base to couple the second topper to the base.
